

GOPHISH CAMPAIGN

Date of Report: October 18, 2025

Framework Used: Gophish Open-Source Phishing Framework

Author: Sidhardh D

1.0 Executive Summary

A simulated phishing campaign, codenamed "Insta Campaign," was executed in a controlled virtual environment for educational purposes. The objective was to demonstrate the technical process of setting up and launching a phishing attack using the Gophish framework. The campaign targeted a predefined group of three internal, non-production email accounts. An email masquerading as a security alert from Instagram was successfully delivered to all targets. As of the time of data collection, no user engagement was recorded. The exercise successfully achieved its primary goal of providing practical, hands-on experience with a phishing framework.

2.0 Introduction & Objectives

2.1 Introduction

Phishing remains one of the most prevalent and effective cyber attack vectors. To better understand the mechanics and technical requirements of such attacks, this educational exercise was conducted. The Gophish framework was utilized within a secure Kali Linux virtual machine to simulate a real-world phishing scenario without posing a risk to any production systems or personnel.

2.2 Objectives

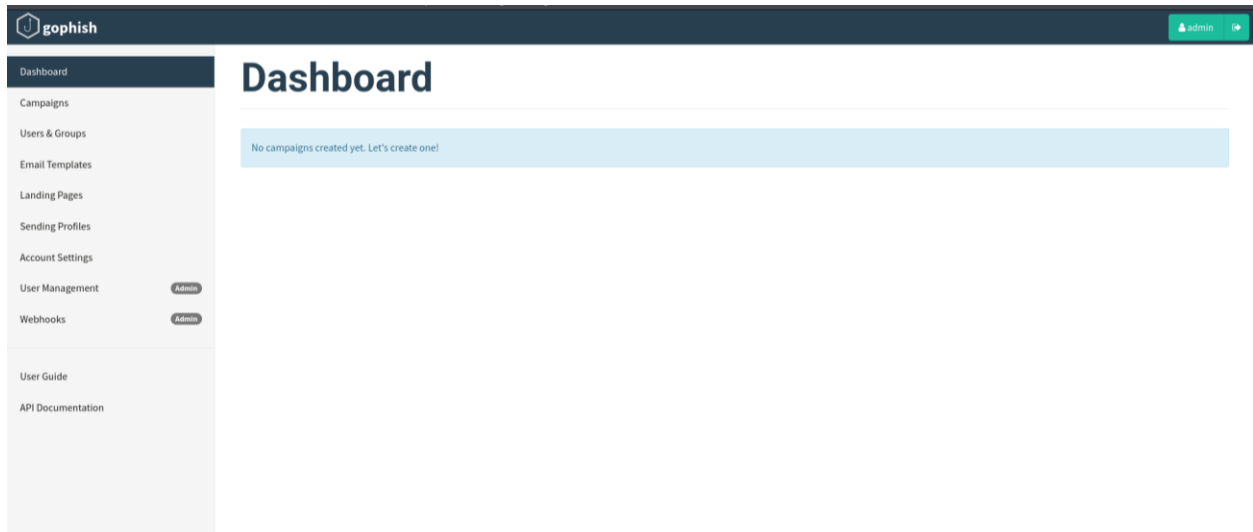
- To successfully install and configure the Gophish phishing framework.
- To configure a sending profile (SMTP) for email delivery.
- To create a target user group, an email template, and a landing page.
- To launch a campaign and verify the successful delivery of the phishing lure.
- To document the entire process with visual evidence for educational purposes.

3.0 Methodology and Step-by-Step Execution

The campaign was executed within an Oracle VirtualBox environment running Kali Linux. The Gophish server was hosted locally, accessible via **<http://127.0.0.1:3333>**.

Step 1: Gophish Initial Setup

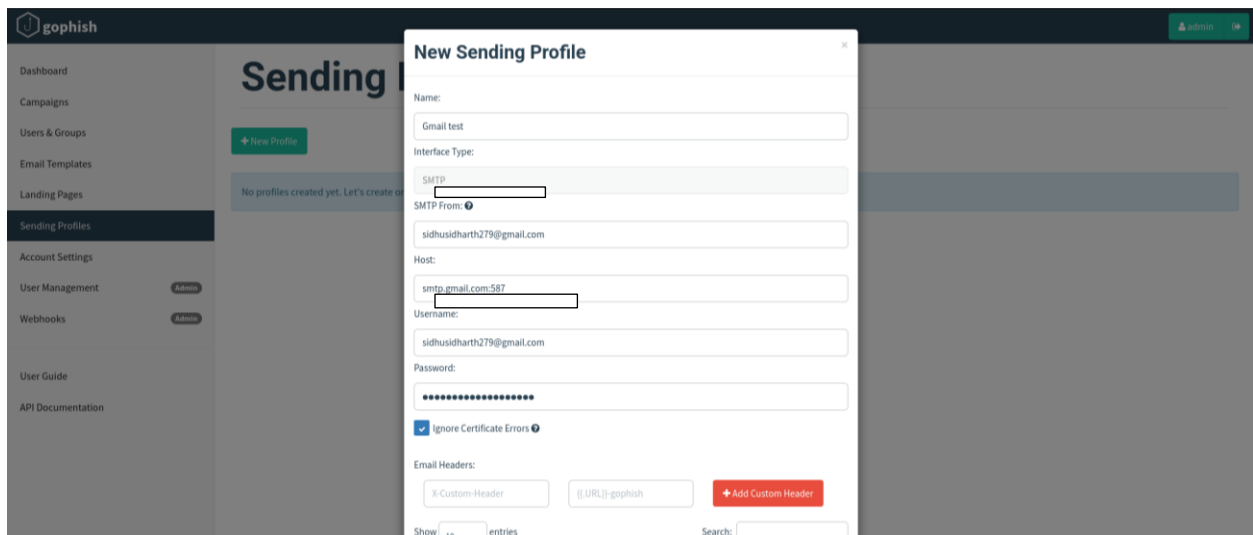
The process began by accessing the main Gophish dashboard, which serves as the central hub for creating and managing campaigns.



Step 2: Sending Profile (SMTP) Configuration

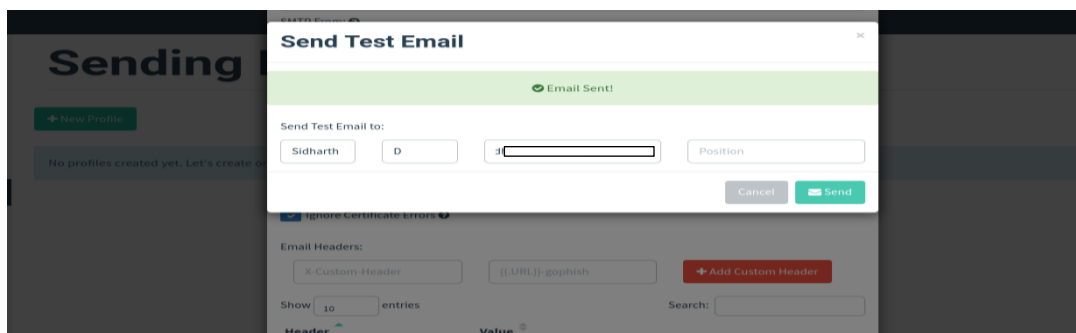
A sending profile named "Gmail Test" was created to allow Gophish to send emails. This was configured using a standard Gmail account and its SMTP server details (smtp.gmail.com:587).

=



Step 3: Sending Profile Validation

The SMTP configuration was validated by sending a test email to a specified address to ensure the connection and credentials were correct.

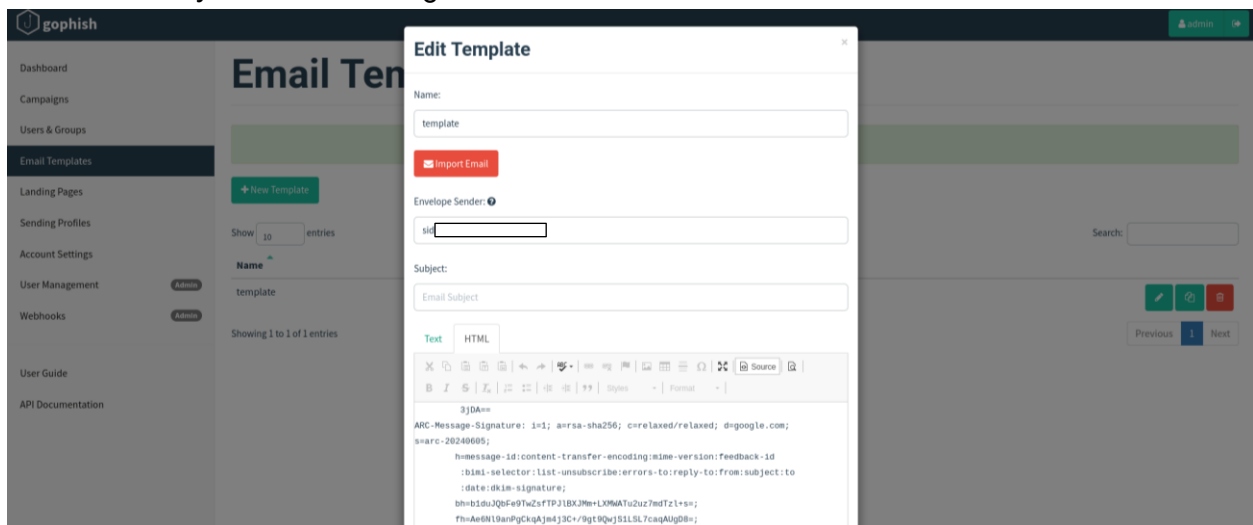


The test email was successfully received, confirming that the sending profile was operational.



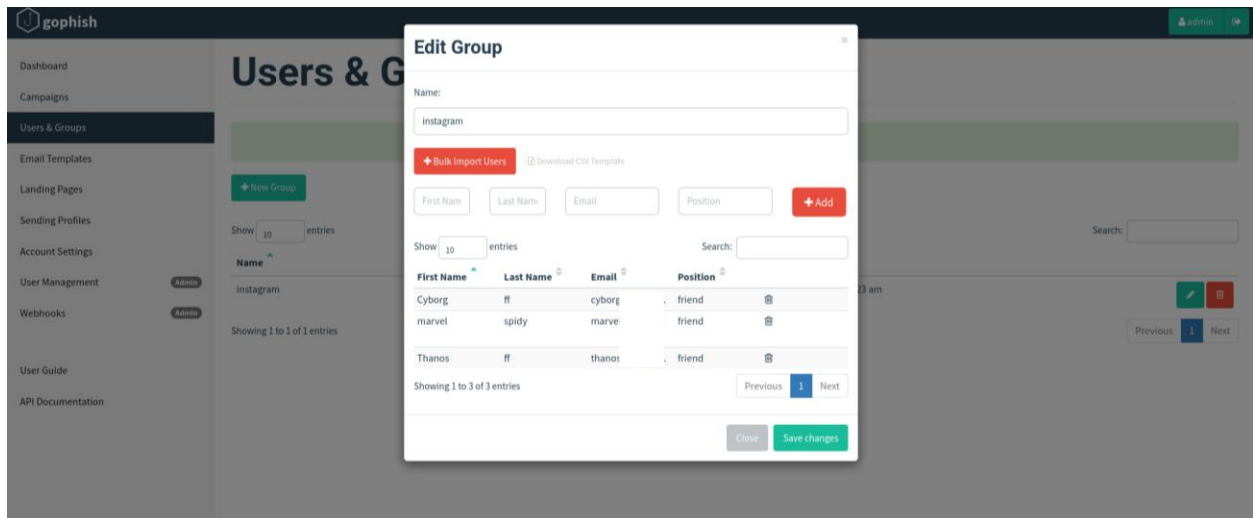
Step 4: Email Template Creation

An email template was created to serve as the phishing lure. It was designed to mimic an official security alert from Instagram.



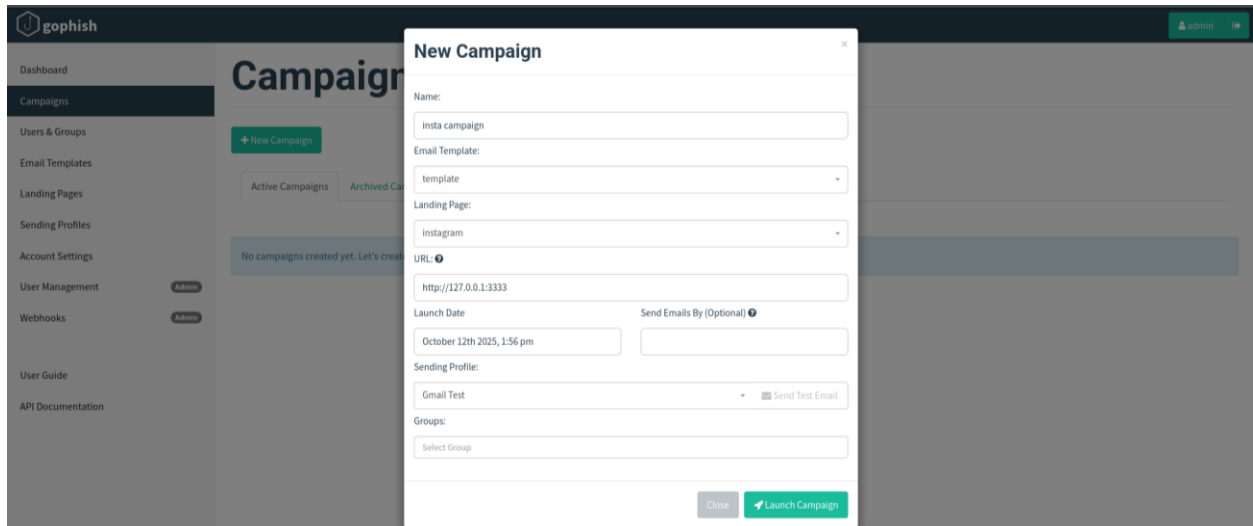
Step 5: Target Group Definition

A user group named "Instagram" was created to house the targets of the simulation. The group contained three fictional users with their respective email addresses.



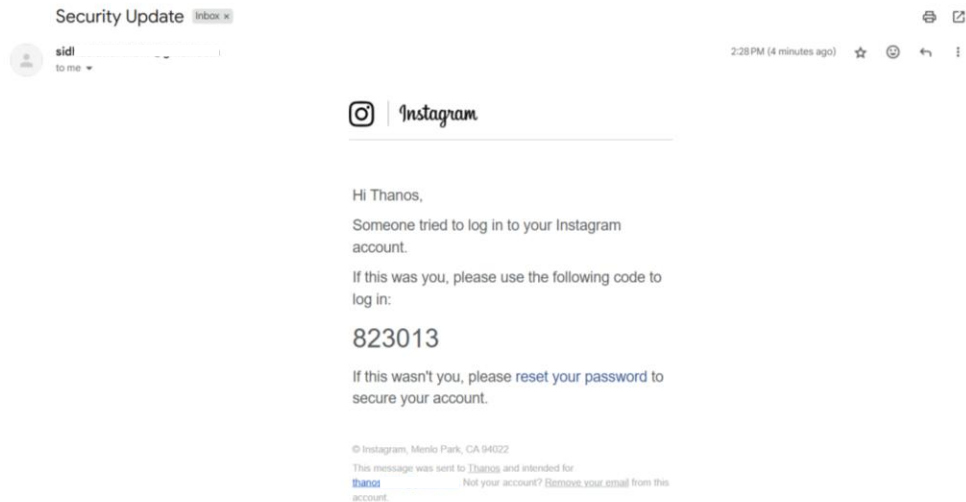
Step 6: Campaign Configuration

All components were assembled into a new campaign named "insta campaign." This step linked the email template, the target user group, the sending profile, and the URL of the Gophish listener.

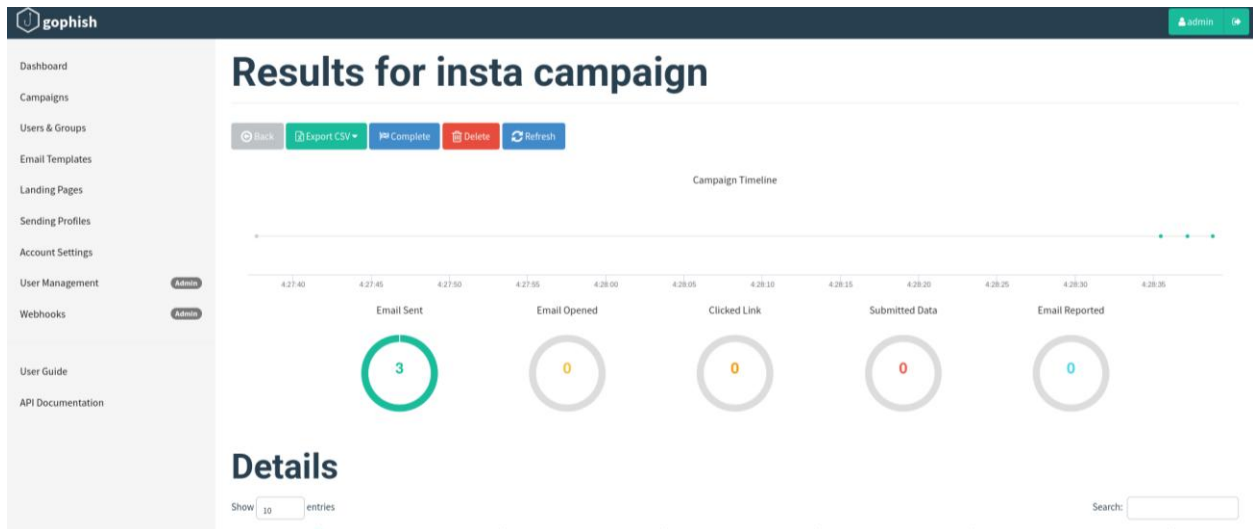


4.0 Campaign Results

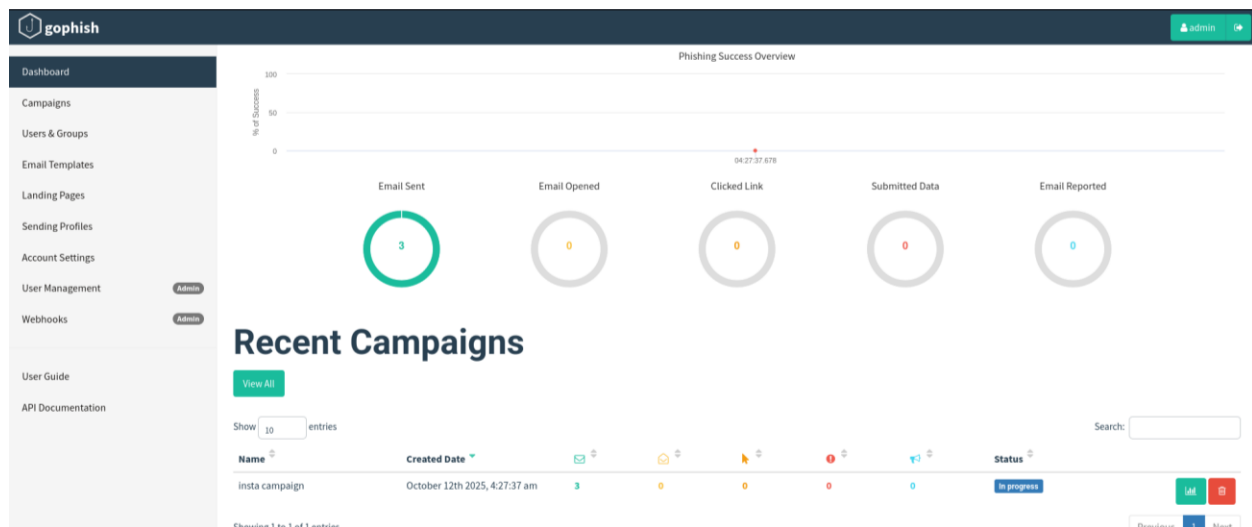
The "insta campaign" was launched, and the phishing emails were successfully dispatched. The screenshot below shows the email as it appeared in the target's inbox.



The Gophish dashboard provided real-time results for the campaign, showing that three emails were sent. At the time of capture, no opens, clicks, or data submissions had been recorded.



The main dashboard provided a high-level overview of the campaign's status and success metrics.



5.0 Conclusion

This simulation successfully demonstrated the end-to-end process of conducting a phishing campaign using the Gophish framework. It served as a valuable educational exercise, providing insight into the relative ease with which an attacker can set up the infrastructure for a phishing attack. All initial objectives, from setup and configuration to successful email delivery, were met and documented.